

Windows 10 Home pre-installed, and a wireless keyboard-mouse combo. It lets you not only execute all your daily tasks but also run medium-intensity games or programs. Priced at \$600, it can be a good purchase for computing anywhere. Just connect it to a screen and you are good to go!

Asus Chromebox

Chromebooks are great options for mini-computers, and Asus delivers one of the most recommendable products in this category. Chromebox from Asus comes in three iterations—basic with Intel Celeron processor, mid-level with Intel i3 processor and higher-level with Intel i7 processor, which is more suited for business users. Here we take a closer look into the i3 model.

The i3-driven Chromebox can connect to any monitor or screen and run up to 4K display resolution. Designed to be sleek and compact, it packs Intel core i3-5010U, 4GB DDR3L RAM and an inbuilt SSD storage of 16GB. It supports both Bluetooth and Wi-Fi connectivity. In addition to four USB 3.0 ports, there is a card reader slot that supports SD memory cards, multimedia cards, SDHC or even SDXC memory cards. You can connect a cable to its Ethernet port. It also comes with an HDMI port, a display port and a 3.5mm headphone jack.

Chromebox runs on ChromeOS and comes preloaded with Google applications. It may also come with a wireless keyboard-mouse combo. Users get a two-year cost-free 100GB



The Asus Chromebox

space on their Google Cloud and three-year warranty on the product. Chromebox costs about \$360 (inclusive of all these features).

iBall Splendo PC-on-stick

Looking like a media-streaming stick, iBall Splendo is a complete computer system miniaturised within a stick that can connect to any screen via USB or HDMI. It is widely used to delicately convert an existing television into a computer system without clogging up space.

Priced at ₹ 6700, the device is plug-and-play. It is powered by a light Intel Atom Z3735F 1.83GHz quad-core processor. Internal storage space is 32GB, of which 24GB is usable, while the rest is preoccupied with the operating system and default software. Splendo runs on Windows 10 and has some useful software pre-installed. RAM is 2GB.

The device comes with a USB outlet, which can directly be plugged into the USB port of a TV set. In addition, there is an OTG port, two USB

ports, an HDMI port and an SD card reader that can expand the storage up to 64GB. Customers also get a 15GB storage space on the OneDrive cloud.

Splendo can wirelessly connect through Wi-Fi or Bluetooth 4.0. The box also comes with a wireless desktop-mouse pair.

Splendo is suitable for daily computing needs like Internet browsing, media streaming, documentation using Office software and basic games. Considering the budget, the offerings are quite diverse. Just plug the device in your TV and you have a Windows computer ready to serve!

Gigabyte Brix

Gigabyte, one of the leading motherboard manufacturers, has joined the



Gigabyte Brix barebone

mini PC race with its own Brix series systems. Aimed at moderate-load operations, Brix delivers reliable portable systems for computing purpose. You can purchase either a completely assembled model or a barebone model, which means partially assembled with room for customisation.

The Brix series comes in multiple iterations specific to user requirements like general-purpose, office or gaming. The processor varies based on the requirement. The basic system includes an Intel Celeron processor. A



iBall Splendo PC-on-Stick